

Bhakti, Sufism and Indo-Islamic Architecture - The Foundation Track

Chapter F5.8 — From Zero: The Bhakti Movement and Its Philosophers, the Sufi Orders, and Indo-Islamic Architecture from the Qutb Minar to the Taj Mahal

Module	Foundation Layer — Module 5 — History, Freedom Movement, Art and Culture
Chapter	Chapter F5.8
Topic	Official syllabus head 1 — Indian Culture and Heritage; Indian Freedom Struggle
Version	v1.0
Compiled	12 August 2026
Exam stage	Recruitment Test (RT)

NOTE · HOW TO USE THIS DOCUMENT

The two subjects held back from F5.7 so that it could carry the political narrative whole, and both are high-yield. The Bhakti movement is the medieval continuation of the argument F5.3 began: a devotional religion open to all, in the spoken languages, against a ritual order fixed by birth. It is taught here through its philosophers, the nirguna and saguna division, and the regional saints, each paired to a language and a region. Sufism is then given in parallel - its vocabulary, its four principal orders with their shrines, and the practices that made it popular. A comparison box sets the two side by side, because the paper tests the distinction. The chapter then takes Indo-Islamic architecture, beginning with the structural change that makes it a new tradition - the arch and dome replacing the post-and-lintel of F5.5 - through the Sultanate phases, the provincial styles, and the Mughal sequence from Humayun's Tomb to the Taj Mahal. Study time 3 hours 30 minutes.

This is the FOUNDATION layer. Dates for individual Bhakti and Sufi saints are traditional and several are disputed by decades; where a range is conventional it is given as such. Attributions of buildings to patrons follow standard reference works. The characterisation of Bhakti and Sufism as mutually influencing is the conventional scholarly reading, but the extent of that influence is debated and is presented as a reading rather than a fact. Architectural terms are given in the forms the paper uses.

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0. Why These Two Subjects Belong Together

A devotional revolt inside Hinduism, a mystical tradition inside Islam, and the buildings raised while both were happening.

WHY THIS EXISTS · WHAT THIS CHAPTER IS, AND THE THREAD IT COMPLETES

F5.3 left an argument unfinished. It showed that the sixth century BCE produced two answers to a ritual religion fixed by birth - Buddhism and Jainism - and a third, **the orthodox tradition's own reform through bhakti, personal devotion open to all varnas and requiring neither sacrifice nor priest.** F5.3 named that third outcome and moved on.

This chapter is that third outcome, a thousand years later and at full strength. The medieval **BHAKTI movement** is the same argument won: by the sixteenth century, devotional religion in the vernacular is the dominant form of Hinduism, and it stays so.

SUFISM is the parallel development inside Islam - mystical, personal, and similarly impatient with formal legalism. **The two ran alongside each other for centuries in the same towns,** and the conventional reading is that they influenced one another. **Treat that as a reading, not a fact** - the extent is debated - **but the shared features are real and examinable:** devotion over ritual, a teacher-disciple bond, music as worship, composition in the spoken language, and indifference to birth.

And the architecture belongs here because it is the same centuries and the same synthesis. F5.5 stopped at the temple. **This chapter takes the buildings raised after the arch and the dome arrive,** which is a genuine structural break and not merely a change of taste.

PYQ CONNECTION · WHERE THE MARKS SIT

- 1 **HIGHEST yield - the four philosophers with their doctrines. Shankara-Advaita, Ramanuja-Vishishtadvaita, Madhva-Dvaita, Vallabhacharya-Shuddhadvaita.** A near-certain matching question, and four facts long
- 2 **HIGH yield - saint to region and language. Kabir, Nanak, Tulsidas, Surdas, Mirabai, Chaitanya, Tukaram, Basavanna, Sankaradeva.** Pure pairing
- 3 **HIGH yield - the nirguna and saguna division,** which is the single organising distinction of the Bhakti topic
- 4 **HIGH yield - the Sufi orders and their shrines: Chishti at Ajmer and Delhi, Suhrawardi at Multan,** plus Qadiri and Naqshbandi
- 5 **HIGHEST yield in the architecture half - the phase-to-building pairings: Qutb Minar and Quwwat-ul-Islam (Slave), Alai Darwaza (Khalji), Lodi tombs and the double dome, Humayun's Tomb, Fatehpur Sikri, Itmad-ud-Daulah's tomb, the Taj Mahal, Gol Gumbaz**
- 6 **MODERATE - the architectural vocabulary: charbagh, pietra dura, jali, pishtaq, mihrab, double dome**

The one structural fact worth more than any pairing: Indo-Islamic building is ARCUATE - it spans openings with arches and domes - where the Indian temple tradition of F5.5 is TRABEATE, spanning with beams and corbels. That single sentence explains why the two look different, and it is asked directly.

STUDY SESSION · CHAPTER F5.8 - THE FOUR SESSIONS

- 1 **Session 1 - The Bhakti movement:** origins in the Tamil south, the four philosophers, nirguna against saguna, and the regional saints (Section 1)
 - 2 **Session 2 - Sufism:** vocabulary, the four orders with their shrines, practices, and the comparison with Bhakti (Section 2)
 - 3 **Session 3 - Indo-Islamic architecture I:** the structural break, the Sultanate phases, and the provincial styles (Section 3)
 - 4 **Session 4 - Indo-Islamic architecture II:** the Mughal sequence from Humayun's Tomb to Aurangzeb (Section 4)
- Then **42 graded questions**.

1. Session 1 - The Bhakti Movement ★★★★★

It begins in the Tamil country in the sixth century, acquires a philosophy, and by the sixteenth is the ordinary religion of most of India.

START FROM ZERO · WHAT BHAKTI IS, AND THE TWO DIVISIONS THAT ORGANISE THE WHOLE TOPIC

BHAKTI means personal devotion to a deity, as the means of liberation. Set against the alternatives it is a radical simplification:

- 1 Not **ritual sacrifice**, which needs a priest and money
- 2 Not **knowledge or philosophy**, which needs Sanskrit and leisure
- 3 Not **austerity**, which needs withdrawal from ordinary life

Devotion needs none of those, which is precisely the point: it is available to a weaver, a woman, an untouchable. That is why the movement's social content is inseparable from its theology, and why it recurs wherever a birth-fixed hierarchy meets a population that can read or sing.

THE FIRST DIVISION - NIRGUNA and SAGUNA. This is the organising distinction of the topic:

- 1 **NIRGUNA bhakti** - devotion to a god **without attributes or form**: formless, imageless, beyond description. **Rejects idol worship, temple, priest and often caste outright.** The nirguna saints are the socially radical wing - **Kabir, Nanak, Ravidas, Dadu**
- 2 **SAGUNA bhakti** - devotion to a god **with attributes and form**, normally **Rama or Krishna**, worshipped through image, story and temple. **Socially gentler and theologically orthodox** - **Tulsidas, Surdas, Mirabai, Chaitanya**

THE SECOND DIVISION - the deity. VAISHNAVA bhakti (Vishnu, and his forms Rama and Krishna) and **SHAIVA bhakti** (Shiva). **The Tamil originators split exactly this way: the ALVARS were Vaishnava and the NAYANARS were Shaiva** - and that pair is a standard question.

Get the nirguna-saguna line right and half this session's questions answer themselves, because a saint's social radicalism, his attitude to images, and often his caste background all follow from which side he is on.

1.1 Origins and the philosophers

The movement begins in the TAMIL SOUTH between roughly the sixth and ninth centuries, with two groups of poet-saints composing in Tamil, not Sanskrit:

- 1 **ALVARS - VAISHNAVA** poet-saints, twelve by tradition, including **Nammalvar** and the one woman, **Andal**. Their hymns are collected in the **Nalayira Divya Prabandham**
- 2 **NAYANARS - SHAIVA** poet-saints, sixty-three by tradition, including **Appar, Sambandar, Sundarar** and **Manikkavachakar**. Their corpus is the **Tevaram**

Then the movement acquires a philosophy. Four thinkers, and this is the highest-yield table in the session.

Philosopher	Doctrine	What it holds, in one line
SHANKARA (Shankaracharya), 8th c	ADVAITA - non-dualism	Brahman alone is real; the world as separately existing is maya, appearance. The individual soul is not similar to Brahman but identical with it. Founded four mathas; the most influential Indian philosopher after the Buddha. Note that Shankara is a philosopher of KNOWLEDGE rather than a bhakti saint - he is placed here because the others define themselves against him
RAMANUJA , 11th-12th c	VISHISHTADVAITA - qualified non-dualism	God, souls and matter are all real; souls are distinct from God but wholly dependent on him. Makes bhakti a valid and sufficient route to liberation, which Advaita does not. The philosophical foundation of Vaishnava devotion
MADHVA , 13th c	DVAITA - dualism	God and the soul are permanently and completely distinct. The most uncompromising rejection of Advaita
VALLABHACHARYA , 15th-16th c	SHUDDHADVAITA - pure non-dualism	Brahman is real and the world is not illusory. Founded the Pushtimarg , the "path of grace", centred on Krishna as Shrinathji
NIMBARKA , 13th c	Dvaitadvaita - dualistic non-dualism	Named for completeness; asked far less often than the four above

The four Vedanta philosophers - the matching question of the chapter

The one-line way to hold the first three, which is how the question is usually framed: Shankara says the soul IS God; Ramanuja says the soul is part of God; Madhva says the soul is NOT God. Three positions on one question, in increasing separation.

KNOW · THE REGIONAL SAINTS - PAIR EACH TO A REGION AND A LANGUAGE

This is pure pairing work, and the language matters as much as the region, because composing in the vernacular is the movement's method.

NIRGUNA - the socially radical wing:

- 1 **KABIR** (15th c) - a **weaver of Varanasi**, in **Hindi** dialect. Attacked ritual, caste, idol worship and clerical authority in both Hinduism and Islam. His verses are the **dohas** and **Bijak**; some are included in the **Guru Granth Sahib**. **The most examinable single saint**
- 2 **GURU NANAK** (1469-1539) - **Punjab**, in **Punjabi**. Founder of **Sikhism**; taught one formless God, rejected caste and ritual, and established the **langar** community kitchen. **Note that Sikhism grows out of this milieu but becomes a distinct religion with its own scripture and line of Gurus**
- 3 **RAVIDAS** - a **cobbler**, and **DADU DAYAL** - Rajasthan. Both in the same nirguna, anti-caste vein

SAGUNA - the devotional mainstream:

- 1 **TULSIDAS** (16th c) - **Awadhi**, the **Ramcharitmanas**, on **RAMA**. **The single most widely read devotional text in north India**
- 2 **SURDAS** - **Braj bhasha**, the **Sursagar**, on the child **KRISHNA**
- 3 **MIRABAI** - **Rajasthan**, a Rajput princess, in **Rajasthani and Braj**, devoted to **Krishna**. **The best-known woman saint**
- 4 **CHAITANYA** (1486-1533) - **Bengal**. Ecstatic Krishna devotion through **kirtan** collective singing; founded the **Gaudiya Vaishnava** tradition

Regional traditions worth naming:

- 1 **MAHARASHTRA - the Varkari tradition: JNANESHWAR** (Dnyaneshwar), whose **Jnaneshwari** is a Marathi commentary on the Gita; then **NAMDEV, EKNATH** and **TUKARAM**, whose **abhangas** are central to Marathi devotion. Focus on **Vithoba of Pandharpur**
- 2 **KARNATAKA - the VIRASHAIVA or LINGAYAT movement**, founded by **BASAVANNA** (12th c). Composed **vachanas** in **Kannada**; **rejected caste, temple ritual and Brahmanical authority** and admitted women. **Among the most socially radical of all the movements**
- 3 **ASSAM - SRIMANTA SANKARADEVA**, whose **Ekasarana** Vaishnavism produced the **sattras** and the **Sattriya** dance of F5.6
- 4 **KASHMIR - LAL DED (Lalleshwari)**, a woman mystic whose **vakhs** are a shared Hindu-Muslim inheritance

HIGH YIELD · WHY THE MOVEMENT MATTERED BEYOND RELIGION - FOUR CONSEQUENCES

This is the "significance" question, and it is worth being able to answer in four points rather than in vague praise.

- 1 **It made the VERNACULAR languages literary.** Awadhi, Braj, Marathi, Kannada, Bengali, Punjabi all acquire major literature through devotional poetry. **F5.6's classical-language list rests substantially on this** - the Bhakti saints are why several of those traditions have an ancient body of work
 - 2 **It offered a religion that did not require literacy, wealth or high birth**, and it was therefore genuinely popular in the strict sense
 - 3 **It produced a sustained internal critique of caste** - most sharply in Basavanna, Kabir and Ravidas. **The critique did not abolish caste**, and it is important to say so, but **it established a vocabulary of religious equality that later reformers used**
 - 4 **It produced a new religion, Sikhism**, and a large number of enduring sects and orders
- The honest qualification, and a panel will respect it.** The Bhakti movement **softened and criticised hierarchy without dismantling it**: most saints' own followings reorganised into communities that reproduced social distinctions within a generation or two. **So the accurate claim is that it changed the terms of religious argument permanently and the social structure only partially** - which is a more defensible thing to say than either "it destroyed caste" or "it changed nothing".

CHECK YOURSELF · SESSION 1

- 1 Define bhakti and state the three alternatives it displaces
- 2 Distinguish nirguna from saguna, and give two saints of each
- 3 Who were the Alvars and the Nayanars, and which deity did each follow?
- 4 Give the four philosophers with their doctrines, and the one-line contrast between the first three
- 5 Which philosopher made bhakti a sufficient route to liberation, and why does that matter?
- 6 Pair Kabir, Nanak, Tulsidas, Surdas, Mirabai and Chaitanya with region, language and deity
- 7 Name the Varkari saints and the deity they worshipped
- 8 Who founded the Virashaiva movement, in what language did he compose, and why is it called radical?
- 9 Give the four consequences of the movement, and the honest qualification about caste

2. Session 2 - Sufism ★★★★★

Mysticism inside Islam, organised into orders, and the reason so many Indian shrines are visited by people of both faiths.

JARGON DECODER · THE VOCABULARY - EVERY SUFISM QUESTION IS PHRASED IN IT

- 1 **TASAWWUF** - Sufism itself: the mystical, interior dimension of Islam, seeking direct experience of God rather than formal observance alone
- 2 **SILSILA** - an **order**, and literally a "chain": the line of spiritual descent from master to disciple. **The four silsilas below are the examinable set**
- 3 **PIR or SHAIKH** - the master · **MURID** - the disciple. **The pir-murid bond is the institutional core of Sufism**, and it is the structural parallel to the guru-shishya relationship
- 4 **KHANQAH** - the hospice or lodge where a pir lived and taught, and where travellers and the poor were fed. **The khanqah is why Sufism spread: it was a social institution, not only a doctrine**
- 5 **DARGAH** - the tomb-shrine of a Sufi saint, and a site of pilgrimage · **URS** - the annual commemoration at a dargah, marking the saint's death, understood as union with God
- 6 **SAMA** - devotional music and listening; **QAWWALI** is its best-known Indian form. **Permitted by the Chishtis and rejected by some other orders**, which is a real point of difference
- 7 **FANA** - the annihilation of the self in God · **WAHDAT-UL-WUJUD** - "unity of being", the doctrine that all existence is one reality, associated with Ibn Arabi. **This is the doctrine closest to Advaita, and it is the basis of the claim that Sufism and Bhakti converged**
- 8 **ZIKR** - remembrance, the repetition of God's names, silent or vocal

2.1 The four orders

Order	Key figures	What to know
CHISHTI	Moinuddin Chishti; Qutbuddin Bakhtiyar Kaki; Baba Farid; NIZAMUDDIN AULIYA; Salim Chishti	The most important and most Indian of the orders. Moinuddin Chishti settled at AJMER , and his dargah at Ajmer is the most visited Sufi shrine in India . Nizamuddin Auliya of Delhi is the other great name, with AMIR KHUSRAU as his disciple. The Chishtis accepted sama and qawwali, kept away from the state and refused official grants , and used the local language - which is why they became genuinely popular. Salim Chishti's tomb at Fatehpur Sikri links the order to Session 4
SUHRAWARDI	Bahauddin Zakariya	Based in MULTAN and Sind. Unlike the Chishtis, the Suhrawardis accepted state patronage, government office and landed property - the clearest contrast between the two orders, and the standard question
QADIRI	Descended from Abdul Qadir Jilani	Strong in the Punjab and the Deccan; later associated with Dara Shukoh , Shah Jahan's eldest son, whose interest in Hindu philosophy and translation of the Upanishads belongs to this milieu
NAQSHBANDI	Shaikh Ahmad Sirhindi	The orthodox and reformist order , insisting on strict conformity to Islamic law and opposing accommodation with Hindu practice . Sirhindi criticised Akbar's policies and the doctrine of wahdat-ul-wujud . The Naqshbandis are the counter-example to the syncretism story, and a good candidate names them for exactly that reason
Firdausi	Sharfuddin Yahya Maneri	Bihar; named for completeness only

The four principal Sufi orders in India

HIGH YIELD · BHAKTI AND SUFISM COMPARED - THE BOX THE PAPER IS BUILT ON**What they share, and these are real:**

- 1 **Devotion and personal experience over ritual and formal law**
- 2 **A teacher-disciple bond** as the route of transmission - **guru-shishya** and **pir-murid**
- 3 **Music as worship** - kirtan and abhanga on one side, sama and qawwali on the other
- 4 **Composition and preaching in the LOCAL language**, not Sanskrit or Persian
- 5 **Relative indifference to birth**, so both attracted people excluded by the formal hierarchies
- 6 **Both produced shrines and pilgrimage** rather than only texts

Where they differ, and this matters for a "not correct" question:

- 1 **Sufism remains within Islam and accepts its prophetic revelation and law**, however loosely some orders held to the latter. **Bhakti operates within Hindu traditions**. Neither is a syncretic third religion, and **an option describing Sufism as a blend of Hinduism and Islam is wrong**
- 2 **Sufism is ORGANISED into silsilas with formal initiation and lineage**. Bhakti is much looser - **there is no Bhakti order, only traditions and sects**
- 3 **Not all Sufis were accommodating**: the **Naqshbandis were explicitly opposed to it**, so the syncretism generalisation fails at the level of the order

The defensible formulation: they were parallel devotional movements, with genuine mutual influence at the popular level and continuing doctrinal distinctness - and the shared shrine culture is the clearest evidence of the first while the Naqshbandis are the clearest evidence of the second. That sentence answers almost any question on the relationship, including an interview one, because it names both the convergence and its limits.

CHECK YOURSELF · SESSION 2

- 1 Define silsila, pir, murid, khanqah, dargah and urs
- 2 What are sama and qawwali, and which order accepted them?
- 3 Explain fana and wahdat-ul-wujud, and why the second matters for the Bhakti comparison
- 4 Name the four orders, and the shrine or region of each
- 5 Give three features that made the Chishtis popular
- 6 State the clearest contrast between Chishti and Suhrawardi practice
- 7 Which order opposed accommodation with Hindu practice, and who led it?
- 8 Name five features Bhakti and Sufism share, and three ways they differ

3. Session 3 - Indo-Islamic Architecture I ★★★★★

A new way of spanning space arrives, and everything else follows from it.

START FROM ZERO · THE STRUCTURAL BREAK - TRABEATE AGAINST ARCUATE

This is the single most important idea in the architecture half, and it is asked directly.

- 1 **TRABEATE** - spanning an opening with a **horizontal beam (lintel)** carried on posts, or by **corbelling**, stepping courses inward until they meet. **This is the Indian temple tradition of F5.5**, and it is why the Harappans and the temple builders alike could not span wide openings. **F5.1 recorded that the Harappans did not know the true arch, and neither did the temple tradition**
- 2 **ARCUATE** - spanning with a **true ARCH**, in which wedge-shaped stones transfer load sideways to the supports, and with the **DOMED**, which is an arch rotated. **This is what Indo-Islamic building brings**

Why it matters structurally, and you will see it faster than most candidates. A lintel works in **bending** and fails in tension, so its span is severely limited by the stone's tensile strength. **An arch works in compression, which is what masonry is good at** - so it spans far more with the same material. **The dome then encloses a large volume without internal supports.** That is why a mosque can have a vast clear prayer hall and a temple cannot.

Two enabling technologies come with it: LIME MORTAR, which lets smaller and less precisely cut stones be bonded into a structural mass, and later the **double dome**.

The other consistent difference is decorative. Islamic practice avoided figural representation in religious buildings, so ornament is **calligraphy, arabesque** (stylised vegetal patterns) and **geometry** - against the figural sculpture that covers a temple. **So the contrast is arch-and-dome plus non-figural ornament, against beam-and-corbel plus figural sculpture.**

JARGON DECODER · THE BUILDING VOCABULARY

- 1 **MIHRAB** - the niche in a mosque's western wall indicating the direction of Mecca · **MIMBAR** - the pulpit beside it
- 2 **LIWAN** - the covered prayer hall · **SAHN** - the courtyard · **IWAN** - a large vaulted hall open at one end
- 3 **PISHTAQ** - the tall rectangular frame around an arched entrance, the dominant feature of a Mughal facade
- 4 **MINAR / MINARET** - the tower, for the call to prayer and for display
- 5 **CHARBAGH** - the **four-part garden** divided by water channels into quarters, the standard setting of a Mughal tomb
- 6 **PIETRA DURA** - inlay of coloured semi-precious stones into marble, forming patterns and flowers. **The signature of the Shah Jahan period**
- 7 **JALI** - a pierced stone lattice screen · **CHHATRI** - a small domed kiosk on a roofline
- 8 **DOUBLE DOME** - two shells, an inner one at a sensible height for the interior and an outer one tall enough to look impressive outside. **Introduced in India in the LODI period and perfected under the Mughals**
- 9 **SQUINCH** and **PENDENTIVE** - the devices that carry a round dome on a square chamber

3.1 The Sultanate phases and the provincial styles

Phase	Where	Buildings and features
Slave / Mamluk	Delhi	QUTB MINAR - begun by Aibak and completed by Iltutmish , the tallest brick minaret of its kind. QUWWAT-UL-ISLAM mosque , Delhi's first, built partly from reused temple material , and using corbelled rather than true arches - so the earliest phase is transitional, Islamic in form and Indian in technique . Adhai din ka Jhompra , Ajmer. Iltutmish's own tomb, and Balban's tomb, which has the first true arch in India
Khalji	Delhi	ALAI DARWAZA (1311), Alauddin Khalji's gateway to the Quwwat-ul-Islam - the first building in India to use the TRUE ARCH and a true DOME on scientific principles , with red sandstone and marble inlay. This is the technical turning point and the single most examinable Sultanate building . Also Siri fort and the Hauz Khas reservoir
Tughlaq	Delhi	Austere, massive and military : grey stone, minimal ornament, and sloping "batter" walls for strength. Tughlaqabad , Ghiyas-ud-din's tomb , Firoz Shah Kotla , Hauz Khas madrasa . The style is deliberately plain, and its austerity is itself the identifier
Lodi	Delhi	Octagonal and square tombs set in gardens - the LODI GARDENS group , including the Bara Gumbad and Sheesh Gumbad , and the Moth ki Masjid . The DOUBLE DOME appears in India in this period, which is the fact asked. Sikandar Lodi's tomb is the type-example
Provincial - Bengal	Gaur, Pandua	BRICK construction with terracotta ornament , and curved "do-chala" roofs copying local thatch. Adina Masjid at Pandua. Brick and curved cornice is the Bengal identifier
Provincial - Jaunpur	Jaunpur	The SHARQI style, distinguished by huge propylon-like screens fronting the prayer hall. Atala Masjid , Jama Masjid
Provincial - Malwa	MANDU	Jahaz Mahal ("ship palace"), Hindola Mahal , and the Jama Masjid . Mandu's buildings are notable for the use of coloured and glazed tile and for scale without ornament
Provincial - Gujarat	Ahmedabad	The most thorough absorption of local Hindu and Jain craft - carved brackets, torans and superb jali work. Sidi Sayyid mosque's jali screens in Ahmedabad are the famous example
Provincial - Deccan	Bijapur , Golconda, Bidar, Hyderabad	GOL GUMBAZ at BIJAPUR - the tomb of Muhammad Adil Shah, one of the largest single-chamber domes in the world , with a whispering gallery. Charminar and Golconda fort at Hyderabad; the Bidar madrasa of Mahmud Gawan from F5.7. Persian and Turkish influence is stronger here than in the north, because the Deccan sultanates looked to Iran directly

Indo-Islamic architecture before the Mughals

The three Sultanate pairings that carry most questions: QUTB MINAR begun by Aibak and completed by Iltutmish; the ALAI DARWAZA as the first true arch and dome on scientific principles, under Alauddin Khalji; and the DOUBLE DOME arriving in the Lodi period. Add Gol Gumbaz at Bijapur for the Deccan and brick-and-terracotta for Bengal, and the provincial styles are covered at recognition level.

CHECK YOURSELF · SESSION 3

- 1 Distinguish trabeate from arcuate, and explain in structural terms why an arch spans further
- 2 What two enabling technologies arrive with the arch?
- 3 State the decorative contrast between temple and mosque ornament
- 4 Define mihrab, pishtaq, charbagh, pietra dura, jali and double dome
- 5 Who began and who completed the Qutb Minar?
- 6 Why is the Quwwat-ul-Islam mosque called transitional?
- 7 Which building first used a true arch and dome on scientific principles, and under whom?
- 8 Give the identifying feature of Tughlaq building, and of the Lodi tombs
- 9 Pair Bengal, Jaunpur, Malwa, Gujarat and the Deccan with one feature or building each

4. Session 4 - Indo-Islamic Architecture II: The Mughals ★★★★★

Four reigns, four materials, one line of development from red sandstone to white marble.

MUST MASTER · THE MUGHAL SEQUENCE - LEARN IT AS A PROGRESSION, NOT A LIST

The Mughal building tradition develops in a single clear direction, and knowing the direction lets you place any building you are shown.

- 1 **BABUR** - little survives; mosques at **Panipat** and **Sambhal**. He recorded his dislike of Indian architecture and his admiration for Timurid gardens
- 2 **HUMAYUN'S TOMB, Delhi** (built under Akbar, by Humayun's widow **Hamida Banu Begum**, architect **Mirak Mirza Ghiyas**) - **the first great Mughal building and the FIRST GARDEN TOMB in India, set in a CHARBAGH**, with a **double dome** and red sandstone with marble inlay. **It is the direct architectural ancestor of the Taj Mahal, and that lineage is the standard question.** UNESCO
- 3 **AKBAR** - **red sandstone, trabeate and arcuate mixed**, and a deliberate incorporation of Hindu and Jain forms. **FATEHPUR SIKRI** is the great ensemble: the **BULAND DARWAZA** (its huge triumphal gateway, raised after the Gujarat conquest), the **PANCH MAHAL** (five diminishing storeys of pillars), the **Diwan-i-Khas** with its famous central pillar, the **Jama Masjid**, and the **tomb of SALIM CHISHTI** in white marble with exquisite **jali** screens. Also **Agra Fort**, the **Lahore Fort** and **Akbar's own tomb at Sikandra**. UNESCO
- 4 **JAHANGIR** - the transition to **WHITE MARBLE and PIETRA DURA**. **ITMAD-UD-DAULAH'S TOMB at Agra**, built by **Nur Jahan** for her father, is **the first Mughal building substantially in white marble with pietra dura inlay** - and is therefore called the "**baby Taj**". Also the **Shalimar Bagh** in Kashmir, and his own tomb at Shahdara, Lahore
- 5 **SHAH JAHAN** - **the zenith. White marble, pietra dura, the bulbous double dome, and the pishtaq facade.** The **TAJ MAHAL** at Agra for **Mumtaz Mahal**, with **Ustad Ahmad Lahori** conventionally named as its architect; the **RED FORT** and **JAMA MASJID** at Delhi; the **Moti Masjid** at Agra; the **Peacock Throne**; and the city of **Shahjahanabad**. UNESCO for the Taj, the Red Fort and Fatehpur Sikri
- 6 **AURANGZEB** - decline in patronage and in quality. **BIBI KA MAQBARA at Aurangabad**, a smaller imitation of the Taj built for his wife; the **Moti Masjid** inside the Red Fort; the **Badshahi Mosque at Lahore**

The progression to state in one sentence: from Akbar's red sandstone with mixed Hindu forms, through Jahangir's introduction of white marble and pietra dura, to Shah Jahan's marble perfection - and then decline under Aurangzeb. Any question asking you to place a Mughal building is answered by material: red sandstone means Akbar, white marble with inlay means Jahangir or Shah Jahan.

HIGH YIELD · THE TAJ MAHAL - THE POINTS ACTUALLY ASKED

- 1 Built by **SHAH JAHAN** for **MUMTAZ MAHAL**, at **Agra**, on the **Yamuna**
- 2 Architect conventionally **USTAD AHMAD LAHORI**
- 3 **White marble** from **Makrana** in Rajasthan, with **pietra dura** inlay of semi-precious stones
- 4 Set in a **CHARBAGH**, with the tomb placed **at the end of the garden rather than at its centre** - a departure from Humayun's Tomb, and a genuine design question
- 5 **A double dome**, four **minarets** slightly inclined outward, **calligraphic** panels of Quranic verse, and **jali** screens
- 6 **UNESCO World Heritage Site**

The comparison that carries the most marks: HUMAYUN'S TOMB is the prototype - first garden tomb, charbagh, double dome, red sandstone with marble inlay - and the TAJ is its perfection in white marble with pietra dura, eighty years later. State the pair and you have answered most Mughal architecture questions in one move.

KNOW · TWO FURTHER TRADITIONS WORTH RECOGNISING

- 1 **SIKH architecture** - the **Harmandir Sahib (Golden Temple)** at **Amritsar**, begun under **Guru Ram Das** and **Guru Arjan**, with the gilding added under **Maharaja Ranjit Singh**. **Its distinctive features are a location lower than the surrounding ground, approached by descending steps, and entrances on all four sides** - both read as statements of humility and openness to all castes and faiths, which connects it directly to Session 1's nirguna bhakti
- 2 **Rajput palace architecture** - **Amber, Jaipur, Jodhpur, Udaipur**, and **Gwalior's Man Mandir**. **A hybrid: Mughal domes, chhatris and jalis on essentially Rajput fortified plans**

And the synthesis point to close on, which is a fair interview answer. Indo-Islamic architecture is **not** an imported style laid on top of India. **The forms - arch, dome, minaret, charbagh - are West and Central Asian; the craftsmen, the stone, the carving traditions and much of the decorative vocabulary are Indian.** Gujarat's jali work, Bengal's brick and curved roofs, and Fatehpur Sikri's bracketed pillars are all Indian craft solving Islamic architectural problems. **The accurate description is a genuine synthesis rather than either an imposition or a continuation.**

CHECK YOURSELF · SESSION 4

- 1 Why is Humayun's Tomb the most important early Mughal building, and name three of its features
- 2 Give Akbar's characteristic material, and four structures at Fatehpur Sikri
- 3 Which building first used white marble with pietra dura, who built it and for whom?
- 4 Name four Shah Jahan buildings, and the material and technique of his style
- 5 Give six facts about the Taj Mahal, including its architect and the source of its marble
- 6 How does the Taj's garden placement differ from Humayun's Tomb?
- 7 What survives of Aurangzeb's patronage, and what does it show?
- 8 Give two distinctive features of the Harmandir Sahib and what each expresses
- 9 State the synthesis argument in one sentence

ACTION · WHERE THIS LEAVES YOU, AND WHAT F5.9 DOES

Medieval India is now complete on both halves - the political narrative in F5.7 and the religious and architectural transformation here. **With F5.5 you hold the whole architectural field, temple and Indo-Islamic alike, and the trabeate-arcuate distinction is the hinge between them.**

F5.9 begins MODERN INDIA: the Company's rise from a trading concern to a territorial power, the conquest of Bengal and after, the **land revenue settlements** whose consequences run into the twentieth century, the transformation and de-industrialisation of the economy, the **social reform movements**, and the **Revolt of 1857** with the rebellions that preceded it.

Then F5.10 takes the freedom movement, from the founding of the Congress to 1947, **with the labour movement running alongside it** - and that is the chapter where Module 5 finally joins the rest of this manual, because the trade unions, the strikes and the early labour legislation of that period are the direct prehistory of the statutes you learned in Module 2 and of the organisation you are being recruited into. **F5.11 then closes the module with a master chronology and a consolidated facts sheet.**

5. Graded Practice - 42 Questions ★★★★★

5.1 Level 1 - Recognition

Q. 1. The doctrine of Advaita, or non-dualism, is associated with

(a) Shankara (b) Ramanuja (c) Madhva (d) Vallabhacharya

Q. 2. Vishishtadvaita, or qualified non-dualism, was propounded by

(a) Shankara (b) Ramanuja (c) Madhva (d) Nimbarka

Q. 3. The doctrine of Dvaita, or dualism, is associated with

(a) Shankara (b) Ramanuja (c) Madhva (d) Vallabhacharya

Q. 4. The Alvars were devotees of

(a) Shiva (b) Surya (c) Shakti (d) Vishnu

Q. 5. The Nayanars were devotees of

(a) Shiva (b) Vishnu (c) Ganesha (d) Krishna

Q. 6. Kabir was by occupation a

(a) cobbler (b) weaver (c) potter (d) goldsmith

Q. 7. The Ramcharitmanas was composed by

(a) Surdas (b) Kabir (c) Tulsidas (d) Mirabai

Q. 8. Mirabai's devotion was directed to

(a) Shiva (b) Rama (c) Vithoba (d) Krishna

Q. 9. Chaitanya belonged to

(a) Bengal (b) Maharashtra (c) Punjab (d) Karnataka

Q. 10. The Virashaiva or Lingayat movement was founded by

(a) Ramanuja (b) Basavanna (c) Namdev (d) Sankaradeva

Q. 11. The dargah of Moinuddin Chishti is at

(a) Delhi (b) Multan (c) Ajmer (d) Sirhind

Q. 12. The Qutb Minar was completed by

(a) Qutb-ud-din Aibak (b) Alauddin Khalji (c) Balban (d) Iltutmish

Q. 13. The first building in India to use a true arch and a true dome on scientific principles was the

(a) Alai Darwaza (b) Quwwat-ul-Islam mosque (c) Qutb Minar (d) Adhai din ka Jhompra

Q. 14. The Gol Gumbaz is at

(a) Golconda (b) Bijapur (c) Bidar (d) Mandu

Q. 15. The Taj Mahal was built by

(a) Akbar (b) Jahangir (c) Shah Jahan (d) Aurangzeb

Q. 16. The first garden tomb built in India was

(a) the Taj Mahal (b) Akbar's tomb at Sikandra (c) Itmad-ud-Daulah's tomb (d) Humayun's Tomb

5.2 Level 2 - Understanding

Q. 17. Nirguna bhakti is devotion to

(a) a god without form or attributes, rejecting idol worship (b) a deity with form and attributes, worshipped through images (c) the sun (d) a living teacher only

Q. 18. The philosopher who made bhakti a valid and sufficient route to liberation was

(a) Shankara (b) Ramanuja (c) Madhva (d) Nimbarka

Q. 19. The Jnaneshwari, a commentary on the Bhagavad Gita, is in

(a) Kannada (b) Awadhi (c) Marathi (d) Braj bhasha

Q. 20. The vachanas of the Virashaiva saints were composed in

(a) Tamil (b) Marathi (c) Telugu (d) Kannada

Q. 21. A silsila in Sufism refers to

(a) an order, being a chain of spiritual descent from master to disciple (b) a hospice (c) a tomb-shrine (d) devotional music

Q. 22. A khanqah was

(a) a tomb-shrine visited on pilgrimage (b) the hospice where a pir lived and taught and where travellers and the poor were fed (c) an annual commemoration (d) a form of silent remembrance

Q. 23. The clearest contrast between the Chishti and Suhrawardi orders is that

(a) the Chishtis rejected music while the Suhrawardis accepted it (b) the Chishtis were confined to Bengal (c) the Chishtis kept away from the state and refused official grants, while the Suhrawardis accepted state patronage and office (d) the Suhrawardis rejected the pir-murid bond

Q. 24. The order that opposed accommodation with Hindu practice, under Shaikh Ahmad Sirhindi, was the

(a) Chishti (b) Suhrawardi (c) Qadiri (d) Naqshbandi

Q. 25. Trabeate and arcuate construction differ in that

(a) trabeate spans with beams or corbels while arcuate spans with true arches and domes (b) trabeate spans with arches and arcuate with beams (c) both use the true arch (d) arcuate applies only to wooden buildings

Q. 26. A charbagh is

(a) a pierced stone screen (b) a four-part garden divided by water channels (c) a domed kiosk (d) a pulpit

Q. 27. Pietra dura refers to

(a) glazed tilework (b) carved brackets (c) inlay of coloured semi-precious stones into marble (d) a double-shelled dome

Q. 28. The double dome was introduced in India in the

(a) Slave period (b) Khalji period (c) Shah Jahan period (d) Lodi period

Q. 29. Tughlaq architecture is identified by

(a) austere grey stone with sloping batter walls and minimal ornament (b) white marble with inlay (c) brick with terracotta ornament (d) profuse figural sculpture

Q. 30. Itmad-ud-Daulah's tomb at Agra is notable as

(a) the first garden tomb in India (b) the first Mughal building substantially in white marble with pietra dura inlay (c) the largest dome in India (d) the earliest mosque in Delhi

5.3 Level 3 - Recruitment Test standard**Q. 31. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer using the code below:**

List-I (Philosopher)	List-II (Doctrine)
A. Shankara	1. Vishishtadvaita
B. Ramanuja	2. Shuddhadvaita
C. Madhva	3. Advaita
D. Vallabhacharya	4. Dvaita

(a) A-3 B-4 C-1 D-2 (b) A-1 B-3 C-4 D-2 (c) A-3 B-1 C-4 D-2 (d) A-2 B-1 C-4 D-3

Q. 32. Which one of the following statements about the Bhakti movement is NOT correct?

(a) Nirguna bhakti rejected idol worship and priestly authority (b) The Alvars were Vaishnava and the Nayanars Shaiva (c) Its saints composed largely in the vernacular languages (d) It abolished caste in the regions where it spread

Q. 33. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer using the code below:

List-I (Saint)	List-II (Language)
A. Tulsidas	1. Braj bhasha
B. Surdas	2. Kannada
C. Tukaram	3. Awadhi
D. Basavanna	4. Marathi

(a) A-3 B-1 C-4 D-2 (b) A-1 B-3 C-4 D-2 (c) A-3 B-4 C-1 D-2 (d) A-4 B-1 C-3 D-2

Q. 34. Consider the following statements about the Chishti order: 1. It accepted sama and qawwali. · 2. It kept away from the state and refused official grants. · 3. It preached in the local language. Which are correct?

(a) 1 only (b) 1, 2 and 3 (c) 2 and 3 only (d) 1 and 2 only

Q. 35. Which one of the following statements about Sufism is NOT correct?

(a) It is organised into silsilas with formal initiation and lineage (b) The pir-murid bond is its institutional core (c) It is a syncretic third religion blending Hinduism and Islam (d) The Naqshbandi order opposed accommodation with Hindu practice

Q. 36. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer using the code below:

List-I (Order)	List-II (Figure or centre)
A. Chishti	1. Multan; Bahauddin Zakariya
B. Suhrawardi	2. Associated with Dara Shukoh
C. Naqshbandi	3. Ajmer; Moinuddin
D. Qadiri	4. Shaikh Ahmad Sirhindi

(a) A-2 B-1 C-4 D-3 (b) A-1 B-3 C-4 D-2 (c) A-3 B-4 C-1 D-2 (d) A-3 B-1 C-4 D-2

Q. 37. Arrange the following in correct chronological order, earliest first: 1. Taj Mahal · 2. Qutb Minar · 3. Humayun's Tomb · 4. Alai Darwaza

(a) 2-4-3-1 (b) 2-3-4-1 (c) 4-2-3-1 (d) 2-4-1-3

Q. 38. Which one of the following statements about the Taj Mahal is NOT correct?

(a) It was built by Shah Jahan for Mumtaz Mahal (b) The tomb stands at the centre of its charbagh (c) Its white marble came from Makrana and it carries pietra dura inlay (d) It has a double dome and four minarets inclined slightly outward

Q. 39. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer using the code below:

List-I (Building)	List-II (Patron)
A. Completion of the Qutb Minar	1. Iltutmish
B. Alai Darwaza	2. Akbar
C. Buland Darwaza	3. Aurangzeb
D. Bibi ka Maqbara	4. Alauddin Khalji

(a) A-4 B-1 C-2 D-3 (b) A-1 B-2 C-4 D-3 (c) A-1 B-4 C-2 D-3 (d) A-3 B-4 C-2 D-1

Q. 40. Consider the following statements: 1. Indian temple architecture is trabeate. · 2. An arch works in compression and can therefore span further than a stone lintel of the same material. · 3. The Harappans used the true arch. Which are correct?

(a) 1 only (b) 1, 2 and 3 (c) 2 and 3 only (d) 1 and 2 only

Q. 41. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer using the code below:

List-I (Provincial style)	List-II (Feature or building)
A. Bengal	1. Gol Gumbaz
B. Jaunpur	2. Brick with terracotta ornament and curved roofs
C. Gujarat	3. Jali screens absorbing local craft
D. Bijapur	4. Huge propylon-like screens fronting the prayer hall

(a) A-2 B-4 C-3 D-1 (b) A-2 B-3 C-4 D-1 (c) A-4 B-2 C-3 D-1 (d) A-1 B-4 C-3 D-2

Q. 42. Which one of the following statements about Mughal architecture is NOT correct?

(a) Akbar's characteristic material was red sandstone (b) Aurangzeb's reign was the zenith of Mughal building (c) Humayun's Tomb was the first garden tomb in India (d) Itmad-ud-Daulah's tomb introduced white marble with pietra dura

6. Answers and Explanations

6.1 Level 1 - answers

Q	Ans	Why, and why the others fail
1	a	Shankara - Brahman alone is real and the soul is identical with it. Hold the three positions as increasing separation: Shankara the soul IS God, Ramanuja the soul is PART of God, Madhva the soul is NOT God
2	b	Ramanuja - God, souls and matter all real, souls distinct but wholly dependent. The philosophical foundation of Vaishnava devotion
3	c	Madhva - God and soul permanently and completely distinct, the most uncompromising rejection of Advaita
4	d	Vishnu. (a) Shiva is the NAYANARS - and the Alvar-Nayanar pair is a standard question, so learn them together
5	a	Shiva , sixty-three by tradition, their corpus the Tevaram ; the Alvars' is the Nalayira Divya Prabandham
6	b	A weaver of Varanasi - and his low-status occupation is part of why his attack on ritual and caste carried force. (a) A cobbler is RAVIDAS , the other great nirguna saint of low caste
7	c	Tulsidas , in Awadhi , on Rama - the most widely read devotional text in north India. (a) Surdas wrote the Sursagar in Braj on the child Krishna
8	d	Krishna. (c) Vithoba of Pandharpur is the deity of the Varkari saints of Maharashtra - a plausible distractor for a devotional question
9	a	Bengal - ecstatic Krishna devotion through kirtan , founding the Gaudiya Vaishnava tradition
10	b	Basavanna , 12th century, composing vachanas in Kannada , and among the most socially radical of the movements - it rejected caste, temple ritual and Brahmanical authority and admitted women
11	c	Ajmer - the most visited Sufi shrine in India. (a) Delhi is Nizamuddin Auliya's , also Chishti, and (b) Multan is Suhrawardi
12	d	Ilututmish completed what Aibak began - the same begun-and-completed pairing as in F5.7, and it is asked in both directions
13	a	Alai Darwaza , 1311, under Alauddin Khalji - the technical turning point of Indo-Islamic building . (b) The Quwwat-ul-Islam used corbelled arches, which is why it is called transitional
14	b	Bijapur - the tomb of Muhammad Adil Shah, one of the largest single-chamber domes in the world , with a whispering gallery
15	c	Shah Jahan , for Mumtaz Mahal , with Ustad Ahmad Lahori conventionally named as architect
16	d	Humayun's Tomb - first garden tomb, set in a charbagh , with a double dome . It is the direct ancestor of the Taj , and (a) is offered because candidates reach for the more famous building

6.2 Level 2 - answers

Q	Ans	Why, and why the others fail
17	a	A god without form or attributes, rejecting idol worship. (b) describes SAGUNA bhakti - and the nirguna/saguna line is the organising distinction of the whole topic, because a saint's social radicalism and his attitude to images both follow from it
18	b	Ramanuja . It matters because Advaita makes liberation a matter of KNOWLEDGE , which requires Sanskrit and leisure; Ramanuja made devotion sufficient , which opened liberation to everyone. That is the theological hinge of the whole movement
19	c	Marathi - Jnaneshwar's commentary, and the founding text of the Varkari tradition
20	d	Kannada - and composing in the spoken language rather than Sanskrit is the movement's method, not an incidental detail
21	a	An order, a chain of spiritual descent. (b) is the khanqah, (c) the dargah, (d) sama - four terms in one question, which is how the vocabulary is tested
22	b	The hospice where a pir lived and taught and fed travellers and the poor. This is why Sufism spread: the khanqah was a social institution, not only a doctrine
23	c	Chishtis refused state patronage; Suhrawardis accepted office and property. (a) inverts the music point - it was the Chishtis who accepted sama and qawwali
24	d	Naqshbandi. Sirhindi criticised Akbar's policies and the doctrine of wahdat-ul-wujud , and the order is the standing counter-example to the syncretism generalisation
25	a	Beams or corbels against true arches and domes. (b) simply reverses the two terms. The structural reason is that a lintel works in bending and fails in tension, while an arch works in compression, which is what masonry is good at
26	b	A four-part garden divided by water channels - the standard setting of a Mughal tomb. (a) is a jali, (c) a chhatra, (d) a mimbar
27	c	Inlay of coloured semi-precious stones into marble - the signature of the Shah Jahan period, introduced under Jahangir
28	d	The Lodi period , and it was then perfected under the Mughals. The double dome exists because an inner shell can sit at a sensible interior height while an outer shell is tall enough to impress from outside - two different design requirements, one structure
29	a	Austere grey stone with sloping batter walls and minimal ornament. The austerity is itself the identifier , and it contrasts directly with the Khalji work that precedes it and the Lodi tombs that follow
30	b	The first Mughal building substantially in white marble with pietra dura - built by Nur Jahan for her father, and therefore called the " baby Taj ". (a) is Humayun's Tomb

6.3 Level 3 - answers

Q	Ans	Why, and why the others fail
31	c	A-3 Shankara-Advaita · B-1 Ramanuja-Vishishtadvaita · C-4 Madhva-Dvaita · D-2 Vallabhacharya-Shuddhadvaita. A near-certain question type and only four facts long - it should never be lost
32	d	(d) is false, and the qualification matters. The movement produced a sustained critique of caste and a vocabulary of religious equality that later reformers used, but it did not abolish caste - most saints' followings reorganised into communities reproducing social distinction within a generation or two. The defensible claim is that it changed the terms of religious argument permanently and the social structure only partially

Q	Ans	Why, and why the others fail
33	a	A-3 Tulsidas-Awadhi · B-1 Surdas-Braj bhasha · C-4 Tukaram-Marathi · D-2 Basavanna-Kannada. The language is as examinable as the region, because vernacular composition is the movement's method
34	b	All three are correct , and together they explain why the Chishtis became the most Indian and most popular of the orders: music, independence from the state, and the local language
35	c	(c) is false. Sufism remains within Islam , accepting its prophetic revelation and law, however loosely some orders held to the latter. It is not a syncretic third religion , and the Naqshbandis in (d) are the clearest internal evidence against that reading. (a), (b) and (d) are all correct
36	d	A-3 Chishti-Ajmer and Moinuddin · B-1 Suhrawardi-Multan and Bahauddin Zakariya · C-4 Naqshbandi-Sirhindi · D-2 Qadiri-Dara Shukoh. Chishti-Ajmer and Suhrawardi-Multan alone resolve the code
37	a	2-4-3-1: Qutb Minar (from 1199, Slave period), Alai Darwaza (1311, Khalji), Humayun's Tomb (1560s-70s), Taj Mahal (1630s-40s). The sequence is the whole architectural chapter in one question
38	b	(b) is false and it is a genuine design point. In the Taj the tomb stands at the END of the garden, on the river front, not at its centre - a deliberate departure from Humayun's Tomb , where the tomb is central. (a), (c) and (d) are all correct
39	c	A-1 Qutb Minar completed by Iltutmish · B-4 Alai Darwaza by Alauddin Khalji · C-2 Buland Darwaza by Akbar · D-3 Bibi ka Maqbara under Aurangzeb. The Buland Darwaza was raised after Akbar's Gujarat conquest , which is why it reads as a triumphal gate
40	d	1 and 2 only. Statement 3 is false and repeats an F5.1 fact: the Harappans used the corbelled arch and did not know the true arch - which is precisely why its arrival with Indo-Islamic building is a structural break rather than a stylistic one
41	a	A-2 Bengal-brick with terracotta and curved roofs · B-4 Jaunpur-propylon screens, the Sharqi style · C-3 Gujarat-jali screens absorbing local craft · D-1 Bijapur-Gol Gumbaz. Bengal's brick and Bijapur's dome are the two easiest anchors
42	b	(b) is false and inverts the sequence. SHAH JAHAN's reign is the zenith; under Aurangzeb patronage and quality decline, and Bibi ka Maqbara is a smaller imitation of the Taj . (a), (d) and (c) correctly give the progression red sandstone under Akbar, white marble and pietra dura from Jahangir, marble perfection under Shah Jahan

7. One-Minute Revision

ONE-MINUTE REVISION · CHAPTER F5.8 - BHAKTI, SUFISM AND INDO-ISLAMIC ARCHITECTURE

WHAT THIS CHAPTER COMPLETES F5.3 named three answers to a birth-fixed ritual order - Buddhism, Jainism, and **the orthodoxy's own reform through bhakti. This is that third answer at full strength**, with **Sufism as the parallel development inside Islam**, and the architecture of the same centuries

BHAKTI - the two divisions that organise everything **NIRGUNA** = god **without form**, rejects idols, temple, priest and often caste - **Kabir, Nanak, Ravidas, Dadu** - the socially radical wing ·

SAGUNA = god **with form**, normally **Rama or Krishna**, through image and temple - **Tulsidas, Surdas, Mirabai, Chaitanya** · second division by deity: **ALVARS** = **VAISHNAVA** (12, incl. **Andal** the one woman, corpus **Nalayira Divya Prabandham**) and **NAYANARS** = **SHAIVA** (63, corpus **Tevaram**), both in **TAMIL**, 6th-9th centuries

THE FOUR PHILOSOPHERS - the chapter's surest question **SHANKARA** - **ADVAITA**, Brahman alone real, the soul **IS** God, world as separate is maya; founded four mathas · **RAMANUJA** -

VISHISHTADVAITA, God, souls and matter all real, soul **PART** of God, and he made **BHAKTI** a sufficient route to liberation, which Advaita does not · **MADHVA** - **DVAITA**, soul **NOT** God, permanently distinct · **VALLABHACHARYA** - **SHUDDHADVAITA**, world not illusory, founded the

Pushtimarg on **Krishna as Shrinathji** · **Nimbarka** - **Dvaitadvaita** for completeness · **the one-liner: Shankara the soul IS God, Ramanuja PART of God, Madhva NOT God**

THE SAINTS - pair to region, language and deity **KABIR** weaver of **Varanasi**, Hindi dialect, **dohas** and **Bijak**, attacked ritual and caste in BOTH faiths, some verses in the **Guru Granth Sahib** ·

GURU NANAK 1469-1539, **Punjabi**, founder of **Sikhism**, one formless God, **langar** · **RAVIDAS** cobbler, **DADU** Rajasthan · **TULSIDAS** Awadhi, **Ramcharitmanas**, **RAMA** - most widely read devotional text in north India · **SURDAS** Braj, **Sursagar**, child **KRISHNA** · **MIRABAI** Rajasthan,

Rajput princess, **Krishna**, best-known woman saint · **CHAITANYA** 1486-1533 **Bengal**, **kirtan**, **Gaudiya Vaishnava** · **MAHARASHTRA VARKARI: JNANESHWAR** (Jnaneshwari in **Marathi**),

NAMDEV, **EKNATH**, **TUKARAM** (abhangas), deity **VITHOBA** of **Pandharpur** · **KARNATAKA VIRASHAIVA/LINGAYAT: BASAVANNA**, **vachanas** in **KANNADA**, rejected caste, temple ritual and

Brahmanical authority, admitted women - **the most socially radical** · **ASSAM: SANKARADEVA**, **Ekasarana**, the **sattras** and F5.6's **Sattriya** · **KASHMIR: LAL DED**, **vakhs**

BHAKTI'S FOUR CONSEQUENCES made the **VERNACULARS** literary (and much of F5.6's classical-language list rests on it) · a religion needing **neither literacy, wealth nor high birth** · a

sustained critique of caste · a new religion, **SIKHISM** · honest qualification: it changed the terms of religious argument **PERMANENTLY** and the social structure only **PARTIALLY** - it did **NOT** abolish caste

SUFI VOCABULARY **tasawwuf** the mystical dimension · **SILSILA** an order, a chain of descent ·

PIR/SHAIKH master, **MURID** disciple - **the institutional core, parallel to guru-shishya** ·

KHANQAH the hospice where the **pir** taught and fed the poor - **why Sufism spread, being a social institution not only a doctrine** · **DARGAH** tomb-shrine, **URS** its annual commemoration · **SAMA**

devotional listening, **QAWWALI** its Indian form · **FANA** annihilation of self · **WAHDAT-UL-WUJUD** unity of being, **the doctrine closest to Advaita** · **ZIKR** remembrance

THE FOUR ORDERS CHISHTI - the most important and most Indian: **MOINUDDIN CHISHTI** at

AJMER, the most visited shrine in India; **NIZAMUDDIN AULIYA** at **Delhi** with **AMIR KHUSRAU** his disciple; also **Qutbuddin Bakhtiyar Kaki**, **Baba Farid**, **Salim Chishti**; **accepted sama, refused state grants, used the local language** · **SUHRAWARDI** - **BAHAUDDIN ZAKARIYA** at **MULTAN**, and

ACCEPTED state patronage, office and property - the clearest contrast with the **Chishtis** · **QADIRI** - **Punjab and Deccan**, later **Dara Shukoh** · **NAQSHBANDI** - **SHAIKH AHMAD SIRHINDI**,

orthodox and reformist, **OPPOSED accommodation with Hindu practice and criticised Akbar and wahdat-ul-wujud** - **the counter-example to the syncretism story**

BHAKTI AND SUFISM COMPARED SHARED: devotion over ritual · teacher-disciple bond · **music as worship** · **the local language** · indifference to birth · shrines and pilgrimage · **DIFFER:** Sufism stays within ISLAM and Bhakti within Hindu traditions - neither is a syncretic third religion · Sufism is **ORGANISED** into silsilas with formal initiation; Bhakti has no order, only traditions · not all Sufis accommodated - the Naqshbandis opposed it · **the formulation:** parallel devotional movements, real mutual influence at the popular level, continuing doctrinal distinctness

THE STRUCTURAL BREAK - the chapter's key architectural idea **TRABEATE** = spanning with beam or corbel - the Indian temple tradition of F5.5, and the Harappans too · **ARCUATE** = spanning with the true **ARCH** and **DOMES** · **why it matters:** a lintel works in **BENDING** and fails in **TENSION**, so its span is limited; an arch works in **COMPRESSION**, which is what masonry is good at - so a mosque can have a vast clear prayer hall and a temple cannot · enabling technologies **LIME MORTAR** and later the **double dome** · ornament is **CALLIGRAPHY, ARABESQUE** and **GEOMETRY**, not figural sculpture

BUILDING VOCABULARY **MIHRAB** Mecca-facing niche, **MIMBAR** pulpit · **LIWAN** prayer hall, **SAHN** courtyard, **IWAN** vaulted open hall · **PISHTAQ** the tall frame round an arched entrance · **CHARBAGH** four-part garden · **PIETRA DURA** semi-precious stone inlay in marble · **JALI** pierced screen, **CHHATRI** domed kiosk · **DOUBLE DOME** inner and outer shells · **SQUINCH/PENDENTIVE** carry a round dome on a square chamber

SULTANATE PHASES **SLAVE:** **QUTB MINAR** begun by **AIBAK**, completed by **ILTUTMISH**; **QUWWAT-UL-ISLAM** with reused temple material and **CORBELLED** arches - transitional, Islamic in form and Indian in technique; Balban's tomb has the first true arch · **KHALJI:** **ALAI DARWAZA 1311** - **THE FIRST TRUE ARCH AND DOME ON SCIENTIFIC PRINCIPLES**, the technical turning point · **TUGHLAQ:** austere grey stone, **SLOPING BATTER WALLS**, minimal ornament - Tughlaqabad, Firoz Shah Kotla · **LODI:** octagonal and square garden tombs (**LODI GARDENS**) and **THE DOUBLE DOME ARRIVES IN INDIA**

PROVINCIAL STYLES **BENGAL** - **BRICK** with **TERRACOTTA** and curved roofs, Adina Masjid ·

JAUNPUR (SHARQI) - huge propylon screens, Atala Masjid · **MALWA/MANDU** - Jahaz Mahal, Hindola Mahal, glazed tile · **GUJARAT** - the fullest absorption of Hindu and Jain craft, Sidi

Sayyid jali screens · **DECCAN** - **GOL GUMBAZ** at **BIJAPUR**, one of the largest single-chamber domes in the world; **Charminar** and **Golconda**; **Bidar madrasa**; stronger direct Persian influence

MUGHAL SEQUENCE - place any building by **MATERIAL** **BABUR** little survives · **HUMAYUN'S TOMB** - the **FIRST GARDEN TOMB** in India, **CHARBAGH**, **DOUBLE DOME**, red sandstone with marble inlay, and the **DIRECT ANCESTOR OF THE TAJ** · **AKBAR** - **RED SANDSTONE**, Hindu forms incorporated: **FATEHPUR SIKRI** with **BULAND DARWAZA** (after the Gujarat conquest), **PANCH MAHAL**, Diwan-i-Khas, **SALIM CHISHTI's** white marble tomb with jalis; Agra Fort; **Sikandra** · **JAHANGIR** - the transition to **WHITE MARBLE** and **PIETRA DURA**:

ITMAD-UD-DAULAH'S TOMB, built by **NUR JAHAN** for her father, the "**BABY TAJ**"; Shalimar Bagh · **SHAH JAHAN** - the **ZENITH**: white marble, pietra dura, bulbous double dome, pishtaq - **TAJ MAHAL** for **MUMTAZ MAHAL**, architect **USTAD AHMAD LAHORI**, **MAKRANA** marble, tomb at the **END** of the charbagh not its centre, four outward-inclined minarets; **RED FORT**, **JAMA MASJID**, Shahjahanabad · **AURANGZEB** - decline: **BIBI KA MAQBARA**, a smaller imitation of the Taj; Badshahi Mosque, Lahore

TWO MORE TRADITIONS **SIKH** - **HARMANDIR SAHIB (Golden Temple)**, Amritsar, under **Guru Ram Das** and **Guru Arjan**, gilded under **Ranjit Singh**; set **LOWER** than the surrounding ground and open on **ALL FOUR SIDES**, both read as humility and openness to all castes and faiths · **RAJPUT palaces** - Amber, Jaipur, Jodhpur, Udaipur, Gwalior's Man Mandir - **Mughal domes and jalis** on Rajput fortified plans · **the synthesis point:** the **FORMS** are West and Central Asian, the **CRAFTSMEN**, stone and decorative vocabulary Indian - a genuine synthesis, neither imposition nor continuation

8. Five-Minute Wall Sheet

FIVE-MINUTE WALL SHEET · CHAPTER F5.8 - BHAKTI, SUFISM AND INDO-ISLAMIC ARCHITECTURE

NIRGUNA = formless, anti-idol, anti-caste: **KABIR, NANAK, RAVIDAS, DADU**

SAGUNA = with form, Rama or Krishna: **TULSIDAS, SURDAS, MIRABAI, CHAITANYA**

ALVARS = **VAISHNAVA** (Divya Prabandham) · **NAYANARS** = **SHAIVA** (Tevaram) · both **TAMIL**
SHANKARA-ADVAITA (soul IS God) · **RAMANUJA-VISHISHTADVAITA** (soul PART of God, made
BHAKTI sufficient)

MADHVA-DVAITA (soul NOT God) · **VALLABHACHARYA-SHUDDHADVAITA** (Pushtimarg,
 Shrinathji)

KABIR weaver of Varanasi · **RAVIDAS** cobbler · **NANAK** founded **SIKHISM**, langar

TULSIDAS-AWADHI-Ramcharitmanas-RAMA · **SURDAS-BRAJ-Sursagar-KRISHNA**

MIRABAI Rajasthan-Krishna · **CHAITANYA** Bengal-kirtan-Gaudiya

VARKARI Maharashtra: **JNANESHWAR** (Jnaneshwari, **MARATHI**), **NAMDEV, EKNATH,**
TUKARAM · deity **VITHOBA**

BASAVANNA: VIRASHAIVA/LINGAYAT, VACHANAS in **KANNADA**, most socially radical

SANKARADEVA Assam · **LAL DED** Kashmir (vakhs)

Bhakti made the **VERNACULARS** literary · critiqued caste but did NOT abolish it

SILSILA order · **PIR/MURID** · **KHANQAH** hospice · **DARGAH** shrine · **URS** · **SAMA/QAWWALI** ·
FANA · **ZIKR**

WAHDAT-UL-WUJUD = unity of being, closest to Advaita

CHISHTI: MOINUDDIN at **AJMER** · **NIZAMUDDIN + AMIR KHUSRAU** at **Delhi** · accepted **MUSIC**,
 refused **STATE** money

SUHWARWARDI: BAHAUDDIN ZAKARIYA at **MULTAN** · **ACCEPTED** state patronage - the key
 contrast

NAQSHBANDI: SIRHINDI, orthodox, **OPPOSED** accommodation - the anti-syncretism
 evidence

Neither Bhakti nor Sufism is a syncretic third religion

TRABEATE = beam/corbel (temples, Harappans) · **ARCUATE** = **TRUE ARCH + DOME**

Lintel fails in **TENSION**; arch works in **COMPRESSION** - so mosques get vast clear halls

Ornament: **CALLIGRAPHY, ARABESQUE, GEOMETRY** - not figural

MIHRAB niche · **PISHTAQ** entrance frame · **CHARBAGH** 4-part garden · **PIETRA DURA** stone
 inlay · **JALI** screen

QUTB MINAR: begun AIBAK, completed ILTUTMISH · **QUWWAT-UL-ISLAM** = **CORBELLED**,
 transitional

ALAI DARWAZA 1311 (ALAUDDIN KHALJI) = **FIRST TRUE ARCH + DOME ON SCIENTIFIC**
PRINCIPLES

TUGHLAQ = austere grey stone + **SLOPING BATTER WALLS** · **LODI** = garden tombs +
DOUBLE DOME ARRIVES

BENGAL brick + terracotta + curved roofs · **JAUNPUR** propylon screens · **GUJARAT jali** (Sidi
 Sayyid)

MANDU Jahaz Mahal · **BIJAPUR GOL GUMBAZ** (huge dome, whispering gallery) · **Charminar**
 Hyderabad

HUMAYUN'S TOMB = **FIRST GARDEN TOMB, CHARBAGH**, ancestor of the **Taj**

AKBAR = **RED SANDSTONE** · **FATEHPUR SIKRI: BULAND DARWAZA, PANCH MAHAL, SALIM**
CHISHTI's tomb

JAHANGIR = **ITMAD-UD-DAULAH's tomb, FIRST WHITE MARBLE + PIETRA DURA**, built by
NUR JAHAN, "baby Taj"

SHAH JAHAN = **ZENITH: Taj MAHAL** (Mumtaz Mahal, **USTAD AHMAD LAHORI, MAKRANA**
 marble)

Taj: tomb at the END of the charbagh, NOT its centre · double dome · 4 minarets inclined
 out

Also Shah Jahan: RED FORT, JAMA MASJID, Shahjahanabad · AURANGZEB = DECLINE, BIBI KA MAQBARA

Place any Mughal building by MATERIAL: red sandstone = Akbar, white marble + inlay = Jahangir or Shah Jahan

GOLDEN TEMPLE: lower than the ground, open on FOUR sides - humility and openness

SYNTHESIS: the FORMS are West/Central Asian, the CRAFT and STONE Indian